



▲ **One of the early GIPR trains** running on Harris Bridge, which was constructed around 1858 near Dapodi, Pune.

The construction for this line was entrusted to English contractors William Frederick Faviell and Henry Fowler. The two employed nearly 10,000 local workers, battling several problems, including working in harsh terrain, communication issues with native workers, and culture clashes. By the end of 1852, the line from Thana to the Masjid Bunder area of South Bombay was complete. At this time, the GIPR undertook trial train runs with the locomotive, *Lord Falkland*, named after the then Bombay Governor.